

“Should Marijuana Be Legalized?”

Dual Enrollment: Criminal Justice
(7th Period Debate – Mr. De Armas)

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Our Answer:

Yes, it should be legalized!

Here are our reasons why



Reason #1: Economic Benefits



- Legalizing marijuana can generate significant tax revenue.

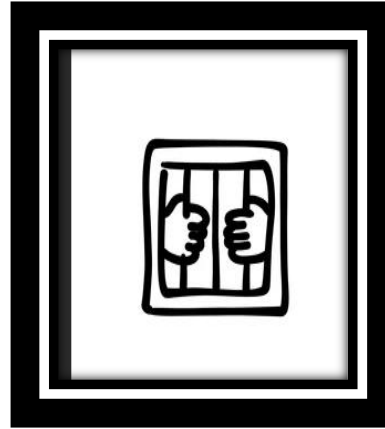
According to the article “Top 10 Reasons to End Marijuana Prohibition” by the Marijuana Policy Project, it states,

“Washington State collecting over \$600 million cannabis sales alone in 2020.”

Based on the article “How Marijuana Legalization Would Benefit the Criminal Justice System” by the Blue Review in Boise State University, it specifies,

“Colorado’s legal marijuana industry has brought in over one billion dollars in tax revenue to the state since it abandoned prohibition. A portion of the tax revenue generated by a legal cannabis industry could be earmarked for police agencies, drug rehabilitation centers, and crime prevention programs.”

Reason #2: Reduction in Crime



- Legalizing marijuana can reduce the burden of arresting those for marijuana-related offenses, therefore decriminalizing and lowering crime rates.

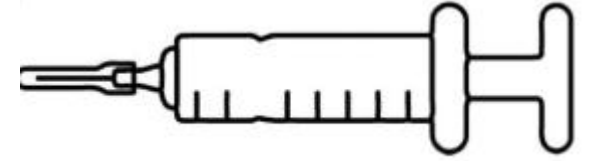
As stated by the article “Top 10 Reasons to End Marijuana Prohibition” by the Marijuana Policy Project, it mentions,

“In 2019, the FBI reported 663,367 cannabis arrests and citations — more arrests than for all violent crimes combined...Data published in Police Quarterly showed a higher percentage of some crimes were solved after legalization in both Colorado and Washington.”

From the article “How Marijuana Legalization Would Benefit The Criminal Justice System” by the Blue Review in Boise State University, it describes,

“When we look at the public health landscape and the effect of legislation, in this case legalization, one of the big benefits is taking cannabis out of the underground illegal market. Taking cannabis out of that particular space is a great idea. You're taking it out of the illegal market and giving it to legitimate businesses where there is going to be oversight and testing of products, so you know what you're getting.”

Reason #3: Medical Benefits



- Legalizing marijuana can provide therapeutic effects to those suffering from addiction to certain substances and widely drop the toll rate down.

Based on the research paper “Public Health Benefits From Legalizing Cannabis: Both Sides of the Coin” by the National Library of Medicine, it clarifies,

“Both the US and Canada are currently dealing with an increase in addiction and death from fentanyl, oxycodone and other opiates. Two large studies have shown about a 25% decrease in deaths from opiate overdose associated with the legalization of medical cannabis and the availability of dispensaries.”

On the article “Five Reasons Why We Should Legalize Cannabis” from The Yale Ledger, a student-led magazine based in Yale University, it emphasizes,

“States that have legalized cannabis found a decrease in opioid overdose deaths and hospitalizations, suggesting that cannabis is an effective alternative to prescription painkillers.”

Reason #4: Social Justice

- Legalizing marijuana will help leverage the disproportionate effects it has on marginalized communities. Examples of this can include stop-and-frisk tactics that are motivated by racial bias.



As discussed in the article from “Five Reasons Why We Should Legalize Cannabis” from The Yale Ledger, it cites,

“Communities of color have been particularly affected by the war on drugs, with Black Americans being nearly four times more likely to be arrested for cannabis possession than white Americans, despite similar rates of use.”



As per the article “How Marijuana Legalization Would Benefit The Criminal Justice System” by The Blue Review, it indicates

Stop-and-frisk tactics have been used in cities throughout the country; however, nowhere has the issue been more salient than in New York City. Throughout the history of the practice used by the NYPD, the overwhelming majority of people stopped-and-frisked were young black and Hispanic men. In the overwhelming majority of these instances, the young men were innocent.”



Reason #5: Environmental Benefits

- Legalizing marijuana can promote environmentally-friendly growing practices.



In line with the article the article from “Five Reasons Why We Should Legalize Cannabis” from The Yale Ledger, it notes,

“Legalization could allow customers to support more environmental growers. This will incentivize more responsible growing practices, such as the use of organic farming methods or the use of renewable energy sources to power indoor grow operations. In addition, the culture of growing cannabis can help to discover and preserve precious marijuana seeds, increasing biodiversity and facilitating a deeper understanding of cannabis plants and their cultivation.



To Really Drive The Point Home!

(Start at 1:50)